



free will
and
determinism

against
compatibilist
free will

A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**

1. No one has any choice about events which happened in the distant past.
 2. No one has any choice about DINOSAUR.
(1)
 3. If determinism is true, then only one future is consistent with the state of the world at a time + the laws of nature.
 4. If determinism is true, then the laws of nature say that if DINOSAUR happens, then DECISION happens. (3)
 5. No one has any choice about what the laws of nature are.
 6. If determinism is true, then no one has any choice about the fact that if DINOSAUR then DECISION. (4,5)
 7. If no one has about choice about whether P, and no one has any choice about whether, if P, then Q, then no one has any choice about whether Q.
-

C. If determinism is true, then no one has any choice about DECISION. (2,6,7)

This argument seems to show that the combination of four theses — that No one has any choice about the past, no choice about the laws of nature, the no choice principle, and determinism — rules out free will.

Since the first three of these theses seem quite plausible, the argument seems to show that if determinism is true, there are no free actions — and hence that free will is incompatible with determinism.

The consequence argument

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe in free will, and find the consequence argument persuasive, it looks tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

But, we'll see now, this argument can also be given a plausible defense.

One way to introduce this defense is with the following quote from

David Hume:

Hume's basic thought is that there is a big difference between free actions and actions which are random or chance.

Here's a thought experiment:

Now ask yourself: is Alex's choice free? It seems very clear that it is not. It is undetermined by facts prior to the relevant run of the Randomizer, but it is random. It is not up to Alex what he does; and free actions have to be up to the person doing the action.

This suggests:

If an act is free,
then the agent
must control
whether it
happens.

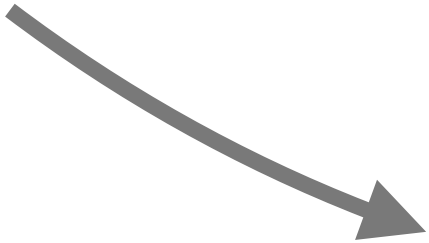
But now consider the idea that free will requires the falsity of determinism. If this is true, then it must be that free actions (or their immediate causes) are undetermined:

If Libertarianism is true, then, if there are free actions, those actions are undetermined by anything prior to the action.

If an action is undetermined, then the agent does not control whether it happens.

If Libertarianism is true, then, if there are free actions, the agent does not control whether they happen.

If Libertarianism is
true, then there are no
free actions.













denterrinnisn



argument

win.

chnoise

theses

about

chnoice

about

past,

nature,

chnoice

principles,

SEEMS

that

rules

four

Thiis

show



free

that

has

l

a

aws

s



there

a

n

y



a

n

d

there

there



there







no





dearminism.

plausible,



argument



actions

Since

SEEMS

henne

first

trude!

theses

theses

quite

there

S

E

E

nn

free

there

with

that

that

W



i

I

I

a

n

d

free

show

the







there











The consequence argument



The master argument against the reality of free will

Recañ

argument:

master

there

consequence

consequence

argument

master

argument

tempting

premise

persuasive,

premise

be: i.e. v.e

win!

defenses

reply

argument

denying

look



find

you

(2)



free

there

and

There

the













by





given

we

!

|

|

S

E

E

now?

this is

C

G

n

argument

But,

be

also



plausible

defenses.



way

One



introduce

this is

defenses



there

with

following

from

quotes

David

hune: 2

big

Humans!

basic

thought



there

that



detwween



actions

differe nces

and

free

random

Whicn



actions

channe.





thought

experiment:

Here's

no

own

free?

re|evant

a

s

k

yourself:

that

clear

undermined

Alex's

facts



by



prior

but

thre

the

choice







SEEMING



U

P





U

P



have

randomn.

no. 1

verv

ne

not

Alex

what

action.

be



Randomizer,

PERSON







and

doing





free

the

actions

does;



the

sugggests:

Thiis



agert

all

2

3

4



harpers.

derin



iii

iv

v

vi





wide and tight

COINTEL

firee,

(or

falsity

the

B

u

t



that



be

nn

uu

ss

tt

W





consider

the



dearminism.



innendiaate

free

undermined:

actions

requires

causes)



that

this is

their

then

free



idea



trwe,



videtur in iud



ti ve,

actinoids,

1d0s0

t

in

e

therein,



acai in 10 in 5

3

1

0

ac + i o i .



by



anythin'g





Prinor



theire



vindeirinha,;

in

o

+

thein



ac tin



all

does





harpers.

agert

colorful

width and width









the air







Q

I

Q

act in order,

therein,

tiive,

agert

widthed in

11

0

+

does

they

colorful

harpier.



t

nd

e

in

3

I

Q

u

u

e

u

e





tiive,

acai in 10 in 5.









puzzle

I

a

y

we

reality



ag·a·in·st

terms

IV O





distants

wind

adornit

chris



aiiv

ever into us

tinne



stare

World



wind





DEBIRION

the

i

10



1234

INDIANBAR.

adornit

Parast.



therein

1234



chris





ivirre

therein

isn't it? e.

the

the

10



NO



123456789

aiiv

123456789

only

22V

the

is it in the

tiwle,

trist





12345

harpers,

harpers.





tdst

DEBORAH DORR.

the

is alive

Widast





123456789

1234

abovet

chris

airid

10





ist

INDIANBAR





4,5)



chriiice

abovet

threen

11

0



2100.

11

0

chriicre

children

aiiv

Widerer

P

9

the

with either,

aiiv









2, 6, 7)

abovet



aiiv



adornit

INDIRIN.

11

0



threen

1234

abovet

1234



where there is















































true















compatibility

inconpatibili

believe

rejects

rejects

A

n



de | iever

W



i

I

I





n

o

w







QWERTY

think



PERSON



look

we



either

going

been





for

two

for

premise



premise

Where're

far

arguments



A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "against compatibilist free will" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters, arranged in three lines.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will





























W



i

l

l

.

the





















free



free

W



that



trve



1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

the















premise



premise

free

W



(2)





and





C

G

R



given



this is

following



now

own

have









(3,4)





(1, 2)





3



harpers.

colorful

wide and tight

againt

if ee,

iii

iv

v

vi

therein

2

3

4







21







acai in 012

acai.rio.

actinoids,

anythin'g

tdose

theire

therein,

Prinoidi

alive,



3

1

0











b

y



vinde vinde,

colorful



worldwide

acquiring

againt

does it

tden

in

o

t

ten

all







Is it air in is it

act in order,



COITCOIL

harpier.

therein,

there,

egert

the rise



they

does















acai.ios.

theire

alive,



underin

2

1

0



